

ARTILLERY

The story of artillery in World War II was one of evolution from the firepower of the previous world war. Field pieces gradually became more mobile, ranges increased, and radio communications improved tactical flexibility. One new development, however, was the widespread introduction of rocket artillery, such as the German Nebelwerfer, which were able to cover large areas with a carpet of high explosive. Artillery continued to play a key role in both attack and defence, and this was the reason that the Soviet armed forces described it as the “Red God of War”.

▼ 50MM LIGHT MORTAR 36

Date 1936

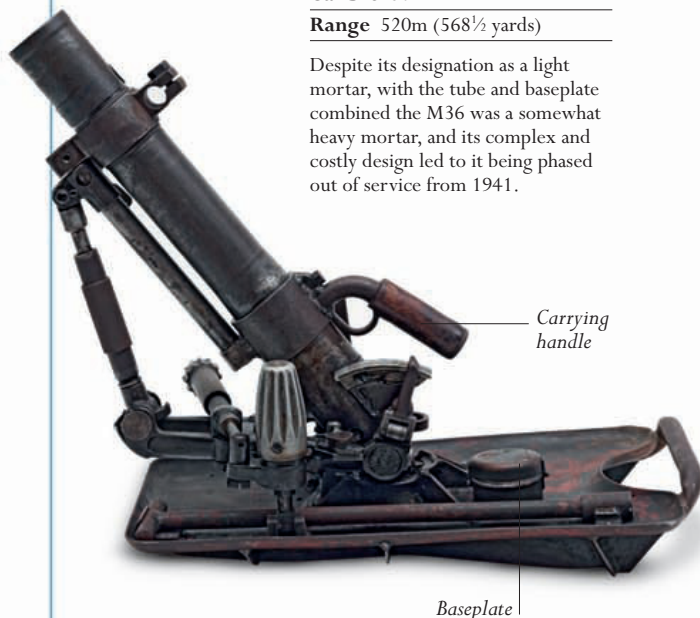
Origin Germany

Weight 14kg (31lb)

Calibre 50mm

Range 520m (568½ yards)

Despite its designation as a light mortar, with the tube and baseplate combined the M36 was a somewhat heavy mortar, and its complex and costly design led to it being phased out of service from 1941.



▼ 122MM M1938 HOWITZER

Date 1939

Origin Soviet Union

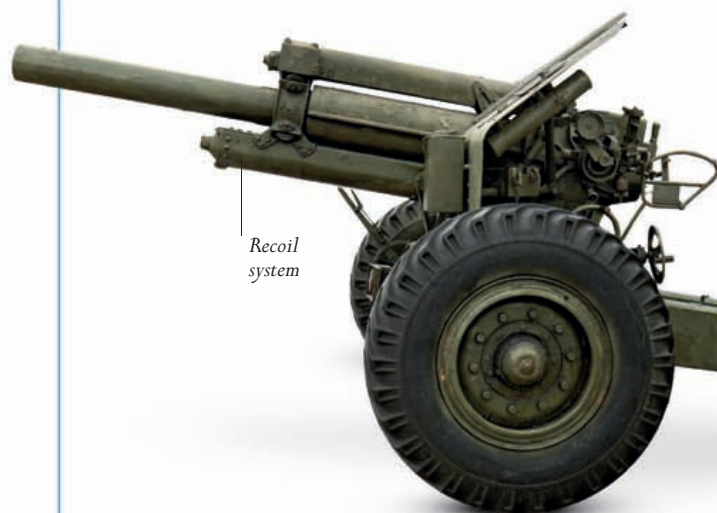
Weight 3.1 tonnes (3.4 tons)

Length 5.9m (19¼ft)

Calibre 122mm

Range 11.8km (7½ miles)

Also known as the M30, this field howitzer was a mainstay of the Red Army's artillery division. Maintained by a crew of eight, it was capable of a rate of fire of six rounds per minute.



◀ 40MM BOFORS ANTI-AIRCRAFT GUN

Date 1934

Origin Sweden

Weight 2.4 tonnes (2.6 tons)

Length 2.25m (7¼ft)

Calibre 40mm

Range 7.2km (4½ miles)

Considered to be one of the finest anti-aircraft guns of the war, combining accuracy, range, and a decent-sized projectile, the Bofors was exported throughout the world, and used by both Axis and Allied armies.



Muzzle brake

Long 40-calibre barrel

▶ 155MM M1A1 GUN

Date 1941

Origin US

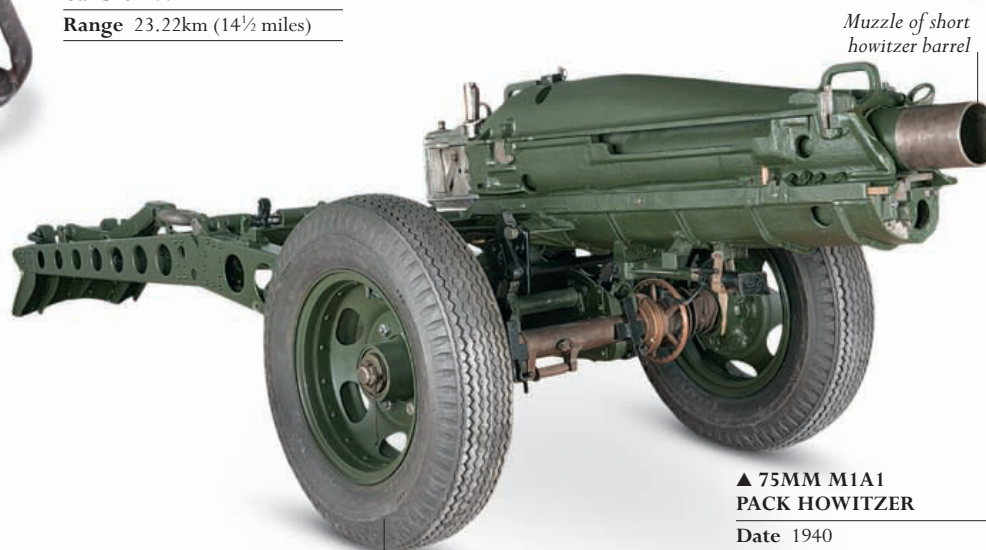
Weight 13.9 tonnes (15.3 tons)

Length 7.36m (24ft)

Calibre 155mm

Range 23.22km (14½ miles)

The M1A1 was the mainstay of US long-range artillery during World War II, capable of firing a 43kg (95lb) high-explosive shell. Other ammunition included smoke, chemical, illuminating, and even anti-tank rounds.



Steel wheels and pneumatic tyres of M8 carriage

Trail handles

▲ 75MM M1A1 PACK HOWITZER

Date 1940

Origin US

Weight 653kg (1,440lb)

Length 3.68m (12ft)

Calibre 75mm

Range 8.79km (5½ miles)

Developed for use on rough terrain, where it could be broken down into separate pieces to be carried by pack animals, the lightweight M1A1 howitzer was also successfully assigned to US airborne forces.

